

Context of use for repeated host-response RNA scores

Use scenario	Current evidence	Boundary for interpretation
Baseline adjunctive diagnosis	Indirect	Do not describe as newly validated baseline diagnostic performance.
Repeat testing at 24 h	Supported: score change	Sampling time must be stated with every score.
Repeat testing at 48 h	Supported with caution	T48 evidence is more vulnerable to dropout and recovery-state selection.
Treatment-response monitoring	Limited E2 anchor	Do not use pathway coupling as proof of treatment responsiveness.
Prognostic assessment	Exploratory only	No mortality association is interpreted as prognostic validation.
Clinical decision support	Not supported	Current evidence cannot guide treatment.

The current study supports temporal description, not assay thresholds, prognostic validation or treatment decisions.